

JOCHEM VANAGT

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EDUCATION

2022 – 2026	Ph.D. in Political Science	UNIVERSITY OF ANTWERP & KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
	– Dissertation: <i>Beyond the Two-Party Divide: How Coalition Dynamics and Ideological Orientations Redefine Affective Polarization in Europe</i> – Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Stefaan Walgrave (University of Antwerp), Prof. Dr. Ellen Claes (KU Leuven), Dr. Luana Russo (Maastricht University)	
03.2024 – 05.2024	Visiting Researcher	UNIVERSITY OF VIENNA, AUSTRIA
2020 – 2022	M.Sc. (research) in European Studies	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	– Distinction: <i>Cum Laude</i> (GPA: 88%) – Thesis title: <i>For Richer or For Poorer, Polarisation Affects Us All: A Two-Stage Comparative Analysis of the Economic Foundations of Affective Polarisation in Europe</i> (grade: 9/10) – Specialisations: Quantitative Methodology, Survey Research Design, Governance & Representation	
2017 – 2020	B.Sc. in Medicine	ANTWERP UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM
	– Distinction: <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> (GPA: 77%) – Medical internships: human genetics, cardiology, gastroenterology – Summer courses: genetic engineering (Aarhus University, Denmark), international business and political science (King's College London, United Kingdom), macro-economics and financial investment (Maastricht University, Netherlands)	

RESEARCH

Research Fields: Political Behaviour, Comparative Politics, Political Psychology

Research Interests: Affective Polarisation, Partisanship, Radical-Right Support, Political Involvement, Democratic Support [†]

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- (5) **Vanagt, J.**, Praprotnik, K., Russo, L. & Wagner, M. (2025) Partisan Affect and Political Tolerance in the Context of Shifting Norms: The Effect of Coalition Signals towards the Radical Right. *Journal of European Public Policy*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2025.2558980>
- (4) **Vanagt, J.**[†] & Kollberg, M.[†] (2025) United in Success, Fragmented in Failure: The Moderating Effect of Perceived Government Performance on Affective Polarisation between Coalition Partners. *European Journal of Political Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.70012>
- (3) **Vanagt, J.** & Russo, L. (2024) The Economic Divide That Isn't: A Comparative Study on Economic Hardship and Affective Polarisation. *Research & Politics*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680241292410>
- (2) **Vanagt, J.**, Praprotnik, K., Russo, L. & Wagner, M. (2024) Affective Polarization Among Radical-Right Supporters: Dislike Differentiation and Democratic Support. *Politics and Governance*. <https://doi.org/10.17645/pag.8531>
- (1) **Vanagt, J.** (2024) Appraising Measurements of Affective Polarisation in Multiparty Systems: Comparative Insights from the Low Countries. *Politics of the Low Countries. Online First*. <https://doi.org/10.5553/PLC/.000068>.

[†]Equal authorship marked with [†]

WORK IN PROGRESS

- (6) Polarized Yet Committed: Why Affective Polarization Might Not Undermine Democracy, *with Emma Turkenburg, Markus Wagner*
- (5) Re-Ostracizing the Radical Right? Quasi-Experimental Evidence from an Election Panel, *with Laura Jacobs, Bjarn Eck, Jean-Benoit Pilet*
- (4) Public support for the cordon sanitaire in Belgium. Exploring the impact of institutionalization, *with Bjarn Eck, Jean-Benoit Pilet, Laura Jacobs*
- (3) Rethinking Political Identity in Europe: Partisan and Ideological Attachment in Times of Affective Polarization, *with Luana Russo*
- (2) Let's (Not) Disagree: How Tolerance for Disagreement Shapes Horizontal Affective Polarisation, *with Luana Russo*
- (1) The Low Countries (Belgium & the Netherlands): Balancing National Diversity with Supranational Integration. In T. D. Lancaster (Ed.), *Comparative European Politics*. Taylor & Francis Group, *with Bjarn Eck*

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

2025	APSA Annual Meeting	VANCOUVER, CANADA
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	GRONINGEN UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	ECPR Joint Sessions	PRAGUE, CZECHIA
2024	ECPR General Conference	UNIVERSITY COLLEGE DUBLIN, IRELAND
	EPSA 14 th Annual Conference	COLOGNE, GERMANY
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
2023	Symposium on Affective Polarisation	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	ECPR General Conference	CHARLES UNIVERSITY, CZECHIA
	EPSA 13 th Annual Conference	GLASGOW, UNITED KINGDOM
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
2022	ECPR General Conference	UNIVERSITY OF INNSBRUCK, AUSTRIA
	UACES Graduate Forum Conference	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	RADBOD UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS

SUMMER SCHOOLS & METHODS TRAINING

2024	Summer school "Democratic Decline and Resilience"	UNIVERSITY OF MONTRÉAL, CANADA
	Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet	
2023	PhD course "Political Psychology"	LUND UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN
	Prof. Dr. Hanna Bäck and Prof. Dr. Magnus Lindén	
	Summer school "Surveying Hard-To-Reach Populations"	UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, UNITED KINGDOM
	Dr. Alessandra Gaia	
	Summer school "Electoral Democracy in Danger?"	SCIENCES PO PARIS, FRANCE
	Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet	
	Workshop "Experimental Methods"	GHENT UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM
	Prof. Dr. Bert Bakker	
	Workshop "Statistical Power Analysis"	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
2022	Dr. Niklas Johannes	

Summer school "Causal Inference and Experiments"	UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, UNITED KINGDOM
Prof. Dr. Ryan T. Moore	
Workshop "Applied Multiple Imputation"	GESIS, GERMANY
Winter school "Multilevel Structural Equation Modelling"	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
Prof. Dr. Bruno Castanho Silva	

GRANTS & FUNDING

2022 ECPR Winter School Participation Grant: £ 465

TEACHING & ADVISING

2025	Public Speaker & Science Communicator	BELGIUM
	Various lectures to general public on <i>Causes and Consequences of Ideological Differences and Emotions in Politics</i>	
2023 – 2025	Tutor & Teaching Assistant	UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM
	Course on <i>European Integration</i> by Prof. Dr. Peter Bursens	
	Course on <i>International Relations</i> by Prof. Dr. Dirk de Bièvre	
	Course on <i>Political Behavior</i> by Prof. Dr. Peter Thijssen	
2024	Guest Lecturer	UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM
	Guest lecture on <i>Affective Polarisation in the U.S. and Europe</i>	
	Keynote Speaker	UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM
	Keynote on <i>The Role of Affective Polarisation and Radical Partisanship in the 2024 US Elections</i> at the <i>UAntwerpen American Election Night Event</i>	
2022 – 2024	Thesis Advisor	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
	3 master students	
2022	Tutor	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	Bachelor course <i>Introduction to Quantitative Methods</i>	
2021 – 2022	Student Assistant Supervisor	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	Supervising 2 bachelor students in interdisciplinary research project with Dr. Luana Russo and Dr. Darian Meacham	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021 – 2022	Research Assistant	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	Project planning, data collection (N = 2,174) and analysis with Dr. Luana Russo and Dr. Darian Meacham	
	Data collection and coding for Dr. Anna Herranz-Surrallés	
2021 – 2022	Research Intern	GESIS, GERMANY
	Data harmonisation and data documentation for the International Social Survey Programme and Horizon-funded <i>COORDINATE</i> project	

MEDIA

2025 News article in *Kleine Zeitung* on joint research
Why the "firewall" against the far right is so fragile

- 2025 Blog piece in *The Loop ECPR's Political Science Blog*
Coalition governments reduce partisan animosity—but only if they perform well
- 2024 Opinion piece in *De Tijd*
Does polarisation threaten to paralyse Europa just like in the US?
- Interview in *De Ochtend*, Radio 1 (VRT)
How consequential is 'affective' polarisation in Belgium?
- News article in *De Morgen* on joint research
Radical-right voters are especially despised, but that matters little to them
- Blog post in *SWAY KU Leuven*
Affective polarisation and the Belgian elections on 9 June 2024
- Interview by *Belga* on affective polarisation in Belgium
Published in *Télésambre*, *7sur7*, *Grenz-Echo*, and *BRF Nachrichten*
- 2023 Blog piece in *Fondation Maison des Science de l'Homme* and *Montreal Centre for International Studies*
How Tolerance for Disagreement Shapes Horizontal Affective Polarization

SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY

- 2024 – 2025 Reviewer for *European Journal of Political Research*, *Government and Opposition*
- 2023 – 2024 Panel Chair
ECPR General Conference 2023, ECPR General Conference 2024
- 2023 – 2024 Co-Developer Voting Advice Application for the 2024 Belgian Elections
Filled out over 6 million times
Winner of the 2025 University of Antwerp Prize for Societal Engagement

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- Statistical software STATA (proficient), R (proficient), SPSS (intermediate), Python (basic)
- Programmes Qualtrics (survey and experimental design), LaTeX, Git/Gitlab
- Languages Dutch (native), English (CEFR C2), German (CEFR C1), Danish (CEFR B2), French (CEFR B1)
- Hobbies Triathlon, harpsichord, violin, choir, marathon

REFERENCES

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